

Audit Pup

Beta Tester Guide

El Dorado County Tax-Aide training

Version 0.16.0

https://jaycarterwells.github.io/audit-pup/

November 2026. For volunteer counselors testing Audit Pup during training.
All case data is fabricated TaxSlayer Practice Lab data.

Welcome, beta testers

Audit Pup checks the TaxSlayer Practice Lab PDF you print after each step of a training case against that case's answer key, line by line. It shows what matches, what does not, and a hint for anything that needs another look. It runs entirely in Chrome: nothing is uploaded, and there is no account to create.

Thank you for testing it. Use it the way you would during class, and tell us whenever something is confusing, wrong, or slow. Your reports decide what gets fixed next.

What is in version 0.16.0

Case	Steps	What it covers
Quinn (Raymond Quinn, 2025)	A, B, D, E, F	Head of household, a W-2, a Medicaid Waiver Payment and the MWP Worksheet, California EITC
Baylor (Michael Baylor, 2025)	15 steps, A to R	Qualifying surviving spouse, several W-2s, unemployment, cancelled debt, election worker pay, jury duty, dependent care, itemizing, HSA, education credit

New in this version: the lines that should still be blank at your step are checked together in **one row**, and if your PDF matches a **different step** than the one you picked, a yellow box tells you which one.

Before you start

- Sign in to your Chromebook with your own account and use a normal Chrome window. **In Guest mode or an Incognito window, your progress is erased when you close the window**, with no warning.
- Open Audit Pup in the Chrome browser, at the address on the cover. Do not open it from a Google Drive preview. Tip: press **Ctrl + D** to bookmark it.
- Audit Pup works on Macs too, in Chrome or in Safari 15 or newer.

Meet the dogs

- **Zeke, chief inspector**, is your guide. His speech bubble at the top of the page tells you what to do next.
- Next to your score, one dog shows how the step went: **Zion, corrections officer** (red ring: something needs fixing), **Bailey, follow-up clerk** (yellow ring: more to do, or a warning is showing), or **Zeke** (green ring: the step is done).



The start page: Zeke's message, the case and step pickers, your progress, the drop box, and the Check button.

1. Save the PDF from TaxSlayer

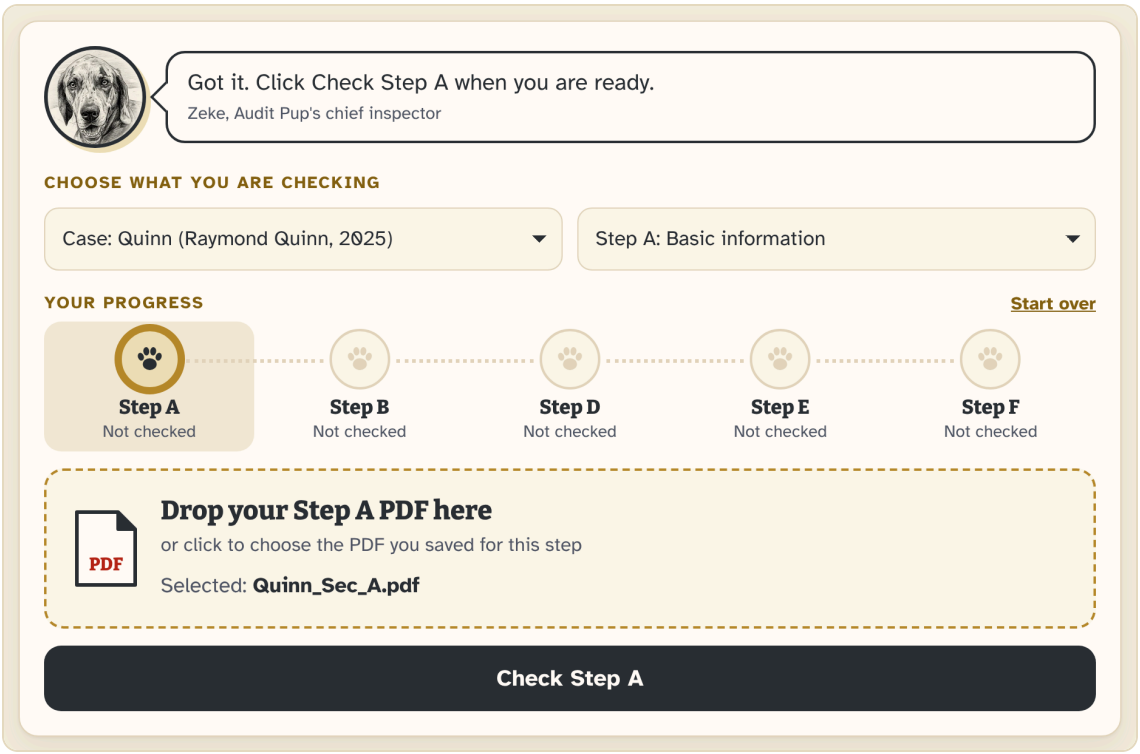
After you finish a step in TaxSlayer, print the full return.

- If the return opens in a new tab, click the **Download** arrow at the top right.
- If a print window opens, set **Destination** to **Save as PDF**, then click **Save**.
- Save it to **Downloads** with a clear name that includes the case and the step, such as *Quinn Step B.pdf*.

> **Print a new PDF after every step.** Audit Pup warns you if you reuse the same file for a later step, because it would be checking your old return.

2. Check the step

1. Pick your **case** in the first box. Audit Pup remembers the case you used last and opens on the first step you have not finished. Make sure the **case** and the **step** match the step you just finished in TaxSlayer.
2. Click the box that names your step, for example **Drop your Step A PDF here**. The Files app opens. Go to **Downloads**, pick your PDF, and click **Open**. (You can also drag the file from the Files app anywhere onto the page.) The file name appears in bold after **Selected:**.
3. Click the button that names your step, for example **Check Step A**.

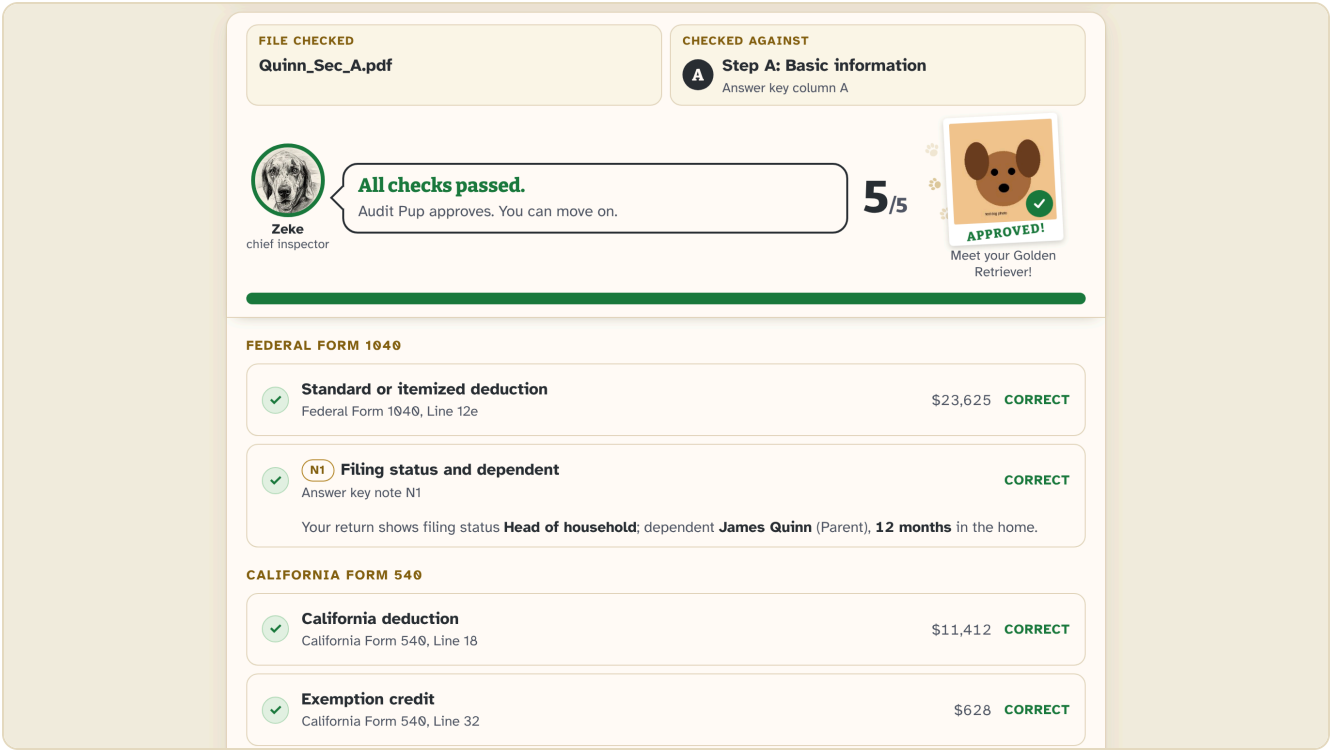


A PDF chosen for Step A. The drop box and the button both name the step.

When a step is done, Audit Pup selects the **next step** for you and clears the old file. Zeke names the next step at the top of the page.

3. Read the results

The score shows how many checks passed. It stays in view while you scroll, together with the file you checked and the step it was checked against. The bar under the score is **red** when something needs fixing, **yellow** while items are left to finish or a warning is showing, and **green** when the step is done.

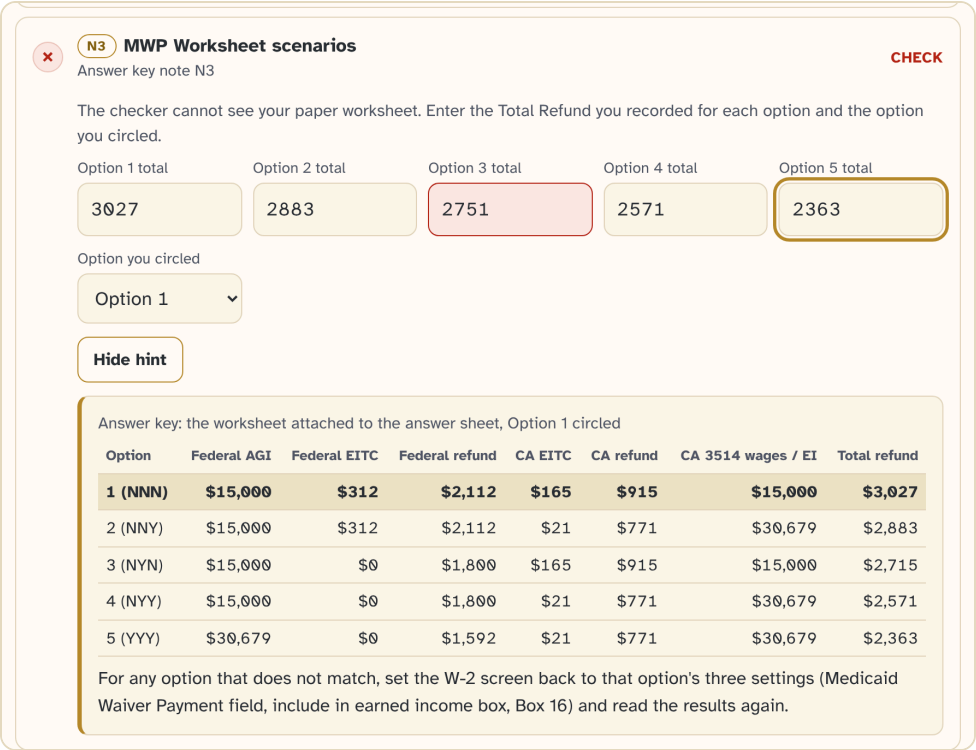


Every check passed: Zeke, a green bar, and the Approved! reward. (Your reward photo will be a real dog.)

Status	What it means
Correct	Matches the answer key. Your amount is shown.
Check	Does not match. Your amount is shown.
Changed	On a no-change step, this line moved since the earlier step.
Form missing	A form the answer key checks is not in your PDF.
Unread	Audit Pup could not find this line. Compare it by hand.
To do	An item you still need to finish yourself.
Confirmed	An item you checked off yourself.

When something needs another look

On a line marked **Check**, click **Show a hint**. The hint gives the answer key value and where to look in the problem. To fix it, go back to TaxSlayer, correct it, print a new PDF, and check again.



A worksheet total typed wrong: the box is outlined in red, and the hint shows the answer key worksheet.

- **Worksheet entries:** some steps ask you to type values from a worksheet you completed, and to pick the option you chose.
- **Items you confirm yourself:** some items, such as a TS Note, are not printed in the PDF. Check the box once you have done it. Click **See an example note** for a sample.
- **Notes Audit Pup checks for you:** some answer key notes, such as an Identity Protection PIN, a Preparer Note, or the address on a W-2, are read from your PDF and show **Correct** or **Check** like any other line.
- **No-change steps:** some steps should show **no change** from an earlier step. The step picker names the step it is compared to.

Lines that should be blank

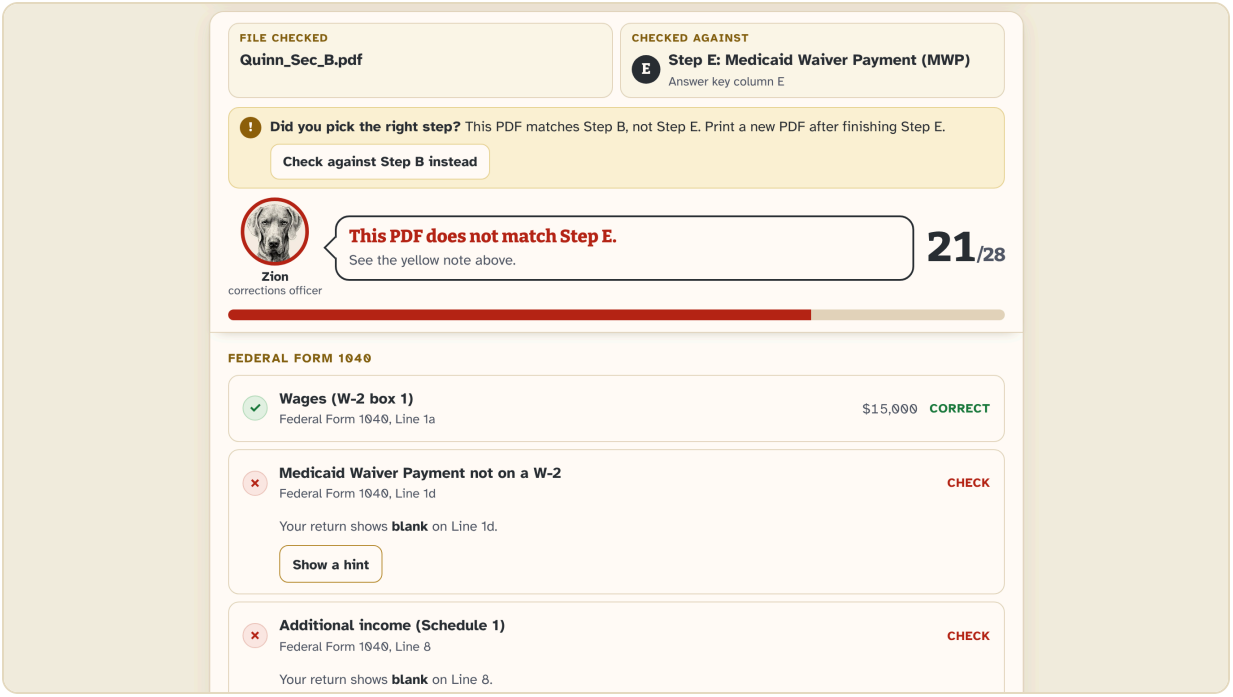
The lines that should have nothing on them yet at your step are checked together, in one row at the end of the list. If any of them has an amount, that row lists each one, and its hint shows the answer key as **blank or $0**.



A Step B PDF checked for Step A: each line that should still be blank but has an amount is listed. Show a hint gives a hint for each one.

Did you pick the right step?

If your PDF does not pass the step you picked but matches a different step (most often the PDF you printed for the previous step), a yellow box names that step. Print a new PDF after finishing your step, or click the button in the box to check against the step it matches. Your progress for the step you picked does not change.



A Step B PDF checked for Step E: the yellow box names Step B.

Your progress

The paw-print trail under the step picker shows each step as **Done**, **Fix**, **To finish**, or **Not checked**. The selected step has a gold ring. Cases with many steps wrap onto two or three rows. Tap a step to select it.

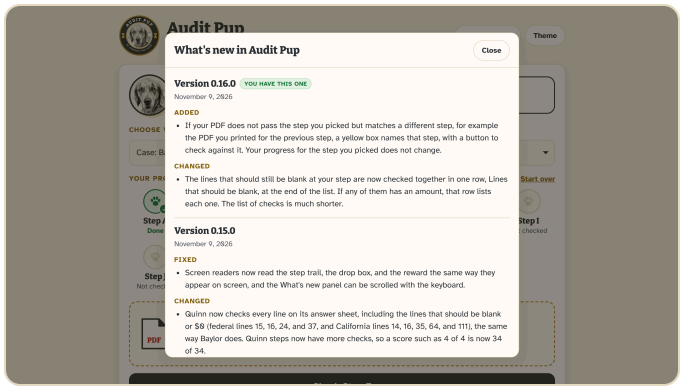


Baylor with Steps A, B, and C done and Step E waiting for its TS Note box.

Each case keeps its own progress, so you can switch cases and come back. Progress is saved **only in Chrome on this Chromebook**. It does not follow you to another computer, and clearing your browsing history erases it. **Start over** (above the trail, on the right) erases the progress for the case you have picked, on purpose. Audit Pup asks first.

Your reward, the theme, and what is new

- When every check passes, every item is finished, and no warning is showing, a random dog photo appears in an **Approved!** snapshot. Tap it for another dog. Without internet you see a green check mark instead.
- The **Theme** button switches between light and dark.
- The **Version** button shows what changed in each version. It has a **New** tag the first time you open a new version.



The What's new panel.



The dark theme.

If something goes wrong

You see	What to do
"That file is not a PDF"	Save the return from TaxSlayer as a PDF and try again.
"Could not read that PDF"	Make sure you picked the PDF printed from TaxSlayer for this step, then try again.
"This is the same file you checked for Step B" (or another step)	You are reusing an older PDF. Print a new PDF after finishing the current step, then check that one.
"Audit Pup did not finish loading"	Reload the page with **Ctrl + R**.
"Audit Pup did not start"	You are seeing a preview. Open the address on the cover in Chrome instead.
"This browser is not saving progress"	Your browser is blocking saved data. Use a normal Chrome window, signed in to your own account.
No dog photo	The reward photo needs internet. Checking still works without it.

Handy Chromebook keys

To do this	Press
Make text bigger or smaller	**Ctrl +** or **Ctrl -** (reset: **Ctrl 0**)
Switch between TaxSlayer and Audit Pup tabs	**Ctrl + Tab**
Open the Files app	**Alt + Shift + M**
Reload the page	**Ctrl + R**
Take a screenshot (for a problem report)	**Ctrl + Show windows**

Known limits in this version

- Audit Pup checks only the lines and notes on the answer key. A mistake that changes no checked line (for example a wrong W-2 Medicare box) will not be caught.
- TaxSlayer does not print TS Notes, so TS Note boxes and worksheet entries rely on you.
- Some steps have the same answers by design (for example Quinn B and D), so their PDFs cannot be told apart. The same-file note covers the usual mix-up.
- Progress is saved in one browser on one computer, and is erased if browsing data is cleared.

Testing checklist

Please try as many of these as you can, and note anything that surprised you.

- [ ] Open Audit Pup from your bookmark, pick a case, and check the first step with your own PDF.
- [ ] Check a step you know has a mistake. Does the hint help you find it?
- [ ] Check a step with the PDF from the step before. Does the yellow box name the right step?
- [ ] Check the same PDF for two steps in a row. Do you see the same-file note?
- [ ] Finish a step with a TS Note or worksheet entries, and tick or type them in.
- [ ] Close Chrome, reopen Audit Pup, and confirm your progress is still there.
- [ ] Switch to the other case and back. Is each case's progress kept?
- [ ] Zoom in with **Ctrl +** to 125% or 150%. Is everything still readable?
- [ ] Try the dark theme, and open the What's new panel.
- [ ] Was anything slow, confusing, or worded in a way you did not understand?

How to report a problem

Send your report to Carter Wells. Include:

1. The **version** (on the Version button, top right) and your device and browser, for example "Chromebook, Chrome".
2. The **case** and **step**, and the name of the PDF you checked.
3. What you **expected**, and what Audit Pup **showed** (the line, its status, and the score).
4. A **screenshot** (**Ctrl + Show windows**), and if you can, the PDF itself. The practice cases use fabricated data, so the PDF is safe to share.

> **Most important to report:** any line Audit Pup marks **Correct** when you know it is wrong. Audit Pup is built so that this never happens, so we want to hear about it right away.

Some hints are new and still being reviewed by instructors. If a hint seems wrong or unclear, please report that too.

Audit Pup 0.16.0. This guide matches the version on the website as of November 9, 2026. The counselor guide in the repository (docs/chromebook-guide.md) is updated with every version.